



Child Friendly School Annual Assessment Report (Endline)

Easy To Learn (E2L) Project in Chhloung District,

Kratie Province

Summary Report



February 2022

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Abbreviations used in this report

BL	Baseline
CFS	Child Friendly Schools
D	Dimension (e.g. D1 = Dimension 1)
DOE	District Office of Education
DTMT	District Training and Monitoring Team
E2L	Easy to Learn
EGRA	Early Grades Reading Assessment
EL	Endline
ML	Midline
MoEYS	Ministry of Education, Youth and Sports

1. Introduction ¹

1.1 Child Friendly Schools

The Child Friendly School (CFS) is a core intervention among the policies of the Ministry of Education, Youth and Sports (MoEYS). CFS has been piloted in targeted provinces by development partners since 2002. In 2004, following field visits, MoEYS leadership decided to develop a national policy to implement the CFS at primary school level from 2005. As a result, the CFS framework was developed in cooperation with UNICEF, Kampuchean Action for Primary Education (KAPE) and Save the Children Norway, to assist in developing documents and implementing CFS activities in various schools. The CFS Policy of MoEYS was published in 2007.

This framework focuses on six dimensions:

1. Equitable access to education
2. Effective teaching and learning
3. Child's health, safety, and protection
4. Gender responsiveness
5. Participation of children, parents, and communities
6. Supports from the education system (leadership and management)

¹ Adapted from: *Child Friendly School Guidelines for School Based Management Committee*, MoEYS (2018)

This CFS policy was expanded to basic education in 2013 by establishing District Training and Monitoring Teams (DTMTs) from within the local District Offices of Education (DOE). DTMTs are responsible for monitoring and support schools' function at local level, with one core task being to conduct monitoring of schools according to CFS criteria; within this, the CFS evaluation checklist is used as a monitoring tool.

In 2016, MoEYS, in collaboration with UNICEF, employed an external evaluation team to assess the ten-year implementation of CFS.² The evaluation raised significant concerns about the implementation of CFS policy and effectiveness of the DTMT work in Cambodia for basic education. CFS implementation in Cambodia continues, and since 2019 the CFS database has been active online (<https://cfs.moeys.gov.kh>).

1.2 Easy to Learn (E2L) project in Chhloung District, Kratie Province

In June 2018, the ChildFund program team with technical support from its Education Specialist and Monitoring Evaluation and Learning Team (MEL), assessed 21 primary schools in Chhloung District, using the Kobo toolbox software. The assessment revealed several gaps that prevent the schools from reaching their desired learning outcomes for children: lack of reading and mathematics toolkits and ICT tools for education; insufficient books or libraries to promote reading habits; unattractive school environment; outdated teaching methodology and materials; poor leadership and management of the school director; low community engagement with schooling; and low capacity of teachers and librarians. Seventeen schools were selected to receive the intervention.

Project Impact:

The project's impact-level aim is *"Improved quality of primary education for children in Chhloung District"*.

Indicator: Dropout rate (boys, girls, Muslim)

Project Outcome (1) is relevant to the current report:

1. To enhance child friendly school environment in 17 target schools

Performance Indicator:

- % of schools with improved facilities increased from 0% (baseline) to 100% by the end of the project
- % schools providing improved education service increased from 0% (baseline) to 70% (endline)

2. Purpose of the Report

This report is to compare the CFS ratings of schools over the previous year (2021) against previous assessments in 2020 and 2019. The comparison will primarily be against the 2019 baseline figures.

3. Evaluation Design and Methodology

The assessment of CFS levels for schools is part of MoEYS policy. The two levels of assessment are (i) School self-assessment, normally carried out by the director; and (ii) DTMT monitoring assessment visits. DTMT

² MoEYS/UNICEF *Joint Formative Evaluation of CFS Policy Implementation in Cambodia April-October 2016 Final Report* Ministry of Education Youth and Sports / UNICEF Country Office, Cambodia, November 2016

monitoring visits are also required to take note of director's self-assessment of CFS indicators and an agreement is reached between DTMT and the director as to the level for each indicator and dimension. Both types of assessment are listed as 'internal assessment,' despite DTMT being an external team. External assessments are carried out by Provincial Inspectors (from the POE) as part of either regular inspection or thematic inspection. Although there are significant overlaps with internal and external assessment, as well as efforts to harmonise the tools, provincial inspection focusses more on teaching and learning and gives a more detailed evaluation of school effectiveness.

Results from CFS internal assessments are posted onto the CFS dashboard and are publicly available. These are the 'official' MoEYS ratings for the schools. Although the CFS dashboard is operational, only 107 DTMTs have yet received orientation training on this from the MoEYS Department of Education Quality Assurance (EQAD); this represents about half the national taskforce for this activity, but fortunately the DTMT teams in Kratie have already been trained to be competent in CFS assessment using the MoEYS tool.

This report will therefore use the secondary data available from MoEYS for the schools' ratings. This is: (i) the preferred method of MoEYS; (ii) likely more accurate than training an additional team of enumerators; and (iii) saves time and does not ask school directors to participate in a very lengthy task during the start of a new academic year.

Previous interventions to assess CFS levels have taken place as part of a detailed assessment with trained enumerators at field level. This has taken around 5-6 working days with a team of 13 assessors (including training). It is the assessments completed by the previously trained enumerators within the DTMT that will inform this report.

4. Findings

4.1 Data Meanings

A school's overall CFS 'score' can be from a minimum of 0.0 to a maximum of 3.0. Scores are graded as follows:

0.00-0.99	Below basic level
1.00-1.69	Basic level
1.70-2.39	Medium (Intermediate) level
2.40-3.00	Advanced level

The overall score is the mean of the scores from the six dimensions. Each dimension is comprised of scores from a number of sub-indicators which are each graded 0,1,2,3 – three being the top score.

The dimensions and numbers of indicators (sub-categories) are as follows:

• Dimension (1) Access:	15 indicators
• Dimension (2) Teaching and Learning:	44 Indicators
• Dimension (3) Health and Safety:	34 Indicators
• Dimension (4) Gender:	10 Indicators
• Dimension (5) Community Participation:	18 Indicators
• Dimension (6) Systems Support:	29 Indicators
Total:	149 Indicators

CFS levels can also be scored by dimension. For example, a score in Dimension (2) of 1.9 would be an ‘intermediate’ rating for a school’s performance in teaching and learning.

The numbers of indicators shown above demonstrate how the significance of indicator changes can vary according to the complexity of the dimension; improvements in dimension (4) can have 4.4x the weighting of indicators in dimension (2). All these issues should be carefully considered when evaluating CFS scores: note also that an improvement in toilet hygiene can affect a school’s score up to fourfold compared with an improvement in mathematics learning.

This is a major weakness of the CFS assessment system and removes schools’ focus away from their core purposes.

4.2 Data Findings Summary

The table below shows the overall results for the schools.

- 1 school: Advanced (2.40-3.00) (green)
- 15 schools: Intermediate (1.70-2.39) (yellow)
- 1 school: Basic (1.00-1.69) (orange)
- 0 schools: Below basic (0.00-0.99) (deep orange)

No	School Name	Total students	Total score	Result
1	Phum Kandal	263	2.27	Intermediate
2	Boeng Kieb	216	1.94	Intermediate
3	Hanchey Leur	714	1.70	Intermediate
4	Hanchey Kroam	217	2.08	Intermediate
5	Kanhcor	189	2.04	Intermediate
6	Preaek Chamlak	672	1.82	Intermediate
7	Somrong	188	2.20	Intermediate
8	Preaek Tahub	251	2.54	Advanced
9	Pong Ro 2	513	1.71	Intermediate
10	Chhloung	701	1.94	Intermediate
11	Prey Ko	252	2.02	Intermediate
12	Prama	441	1.51	Intermediate
13	Veal Kansaeng	289	2.28	Intermediate
14	Phum Thmey	182	2.09	Intermediate
15	Pong Ro 3	478	2.00	Intermediate
16	Chhak Kantoung	205	1.80	Intermediate
17	Kbal Khla	137	1.19	Basic
Mean score:			1.95	Intermediate

4.3 Comparison with previous years

4.3.1 Comparison Endline(Y3) with Midline(Y2)

The first comparison this report will make is between the midline and endline figures. This is important, because both of these assessments were affected by COVID-19 restrictions.

From midline (2020) to endline (2021), 15 out of 17 schools improved their overall score. Of those 15, eleven raised themselves a level; 10 went from basic to intermediate and one went from intermediate to advanced. Prek Tahub Primary School was therefore the first primary school in the project to reach this level, a considerable achievement.

The mean overall score from schools went from 1.66 ('basic') to 1.95 ('intermediate') from year 2 to year 3 assessment. This is a mean gain of +0.29. This is almost identical to the gain from year 1 to year 2, which was +0.28 (14/17 schools improved their ratings).

The table on the next page (and in annex 6.1) summarises the data, showing the performances by dimension and changes from year 2 to year 3. Positive changes are shown in blue, negative results in red.

School Name	Students	CFS EL Y3	Up/Down (ML-EL)	CFS ML Y2	CFS EL Y3 by dimension						CFS Changes Y2-Y3					
					D1	D2	D3	D4	D5	D6	D1	D2	D3	D4	D5	D6
Phum Kandal	263	2.27	0.22	2.05	2.40	2.11	2.61	2.20	2.06	2.25	-0.07	0.34	0.50	0.40	0.25	-0.07
Boeng Kieb	216	1.94	0.37	1.57	2.20	1.86	2.05	1.78	2.24	2.25	0.07	0.37	0.47	0.28	1.11	0.67
Hanchey Leur	714	1.70	-0.58	2.28	1.93	1.26	1.66	2.20	1.46	1.70	-0.47	-0.70	-0.24	-0.30	-0.75	-0.98
Hanchey Kroam	217	2.08	0.41	1.67	1.71	1.89	2.22	2.30	2.31	2.07	-0.09	0.47	0.54	0.50	0.77	0.27
Kanhcor	189	2.04	0.62	1.42	2.27	2.05	2.26	1.80	1.50	2.35	0.41	0.96	0.71	0.90	0.21	0.52
Preaek Chamlak	672	1.82	0.21	1.61	1.47	1.83	1.71	2.00	1.89	2.04	-0.67	0.70	0.22	0.10	0.49	0.43
Somrong	188	2.20	0.23	1.97	2.53	2.04	2.37	2.10	1.88	2.26	0.66	0.09	0.47	0.00	0.19	-0.03
Preaek Tahub	251	2.54	0.29	2.25	2.73	2.31	2.45	2.70	2.38	2.64	0.53	0.23	0.60	0.10	0.26	0.01
Pong Ro 2	513	1.71	0.47	1.24	1.87	1.67	1.37	1.90	1.56	1.89	0.30	0.44	0.41	0.70	0.46	0.49
Chhloung	701	1.94	0.26	1.68	2.14	1.73	1.73	2.00	1.44	2.58	-0.13	0.36	0.46	0.00	-0.04	0.91
Prey Ko	252	2.02	0.98	1.04	2.47	2.03	2.07	2.11	1.71	1.71	0.97	1.19	1.12	0.91	0.87	0.79
Prama	441	1.51	0.18	1.33	1.87	1.36	1.40	1.60	1.47	1.37	0.40	0.00	-0.14	0.10	0.59	0.13
Veal Kansaeng	289	2.28	0.27	2.01	2.27	2.21	2.47	2.10	2.25	2.38	-0.16	0.82	0.57	0.30	0.12	-0.05
Phum Thmey	182	2.09	0.43	1.66	2.80	1.86	1.99	2.50	1.44	1.96	0.51	0.69	0.61	0.60	-0.19	0.35
Pong Ro 3	478	2.00	0.41	1.59	2.40	1.78	2.15	2.40	1.38	1.87	0.76	0.59	0.71	0.30	-0.29	0.39
Chhak Kantoung	205	1.80	0.29	1.51	2.07	1.66	1.56	2.10	1.38	2.01	0.43	0.38	0.33	0.00	0.00	0.59
Kbal Khla	137	1.19	-0.1	1.29	1.29	0.92	0.84	1.60	1.08	1.43	-0.21	-0.33	-0.07	-0.30	-0.05	0.41
	AVERAGE:	1.95	0.29	1.66	2.14	1.80	1.94	2.08	1.73	2.04	0.19	0.39	0.43	0.27	0.24	0.28

Explanatory Note:

CFS EL Y3 = Endline results for CFS (year 3). These are coded as BROWN = Below Basic, PINK = Basic, YELLOW = Intermediate, GREEN = advanced. Bold markings indicate schools that managed to increase a CFS 'level' from year 2 to year 3. At the bottom of the column is the mean – this is also marked in yellow as it is an intermediate level score.

Up/Down (ML-EL) represents the changes in the schools' overall scores from midline to endline. For example, Phum Kandal has improved +0.22 since the midline figure (which is in the adjacent right cell: the EL figure is 2.27, the ML figure is 2.05 so the change is +0.22). Positive changes are marked in blue, negative in red. The coloured cells further to the right represent the endline figures by dimension. On the top left of this section, Phum Kandal scored 2.40 on the endline for Dimension 1.

The right six columns break down the changes midline-endline by dimension, using the blue/red coding as before. Phum Kandal's -0.07 in red in D1 means that their baseline level was 2.47 (2.40 + 0.07).

4.3.2 Summary points of Comparison of endline(Y3) with midline (Y2)

- Mean improvement of schools' score was +0.29
- Total of 15/17 schools (88%) improved their score
- Total of 11/17 schools (65%) improved their score sufficiently to raise their level
- One school, Prek Tahub, achieved advanced CFS level, the first in the project to do so
- Two schools decreased their scores; neither of these affected their overall level, although in one case a decrease of 0.01 would have been sufficient to take HS Hanchey Ler down to 'basic'

4.4 Endline(Y3) comparison with baseline(Y1)

The second comparison the report will make is between baseline (BL) and endline (EL). Note that this is now comparing pre-COVID (2019 baseline) with second year of COVID restrictions (2021).

The headline figure is that 16 out of 17 schools improved their overall score. Of those 16, 14 raised themselves from a level; 13 went from basic to intermediate and one raised from basic to advanced. Prek Tahub Primary School was therefore the first primary school in the project to reach this level, a considerable achievement.

The mean overall score from schools went from:

- 2019 (Baseline): 1.37 (basic)
- 2020 (Midline): 1.66 (basic, but only 0.04 short of intermediate)
- 2021 (Endline): 1.95 (intermediate)

Thus the overall mean gain in improvement is +0.57 CFS 'points'. This was +0.28 from Y1-Y2 and +0.29 from Y2-Y3.

One school failed to improve on the CFS measure from baseline to endline. The consultancy team are aware of the situation of that school and feel that the school has made improvements following a change of leadership.

The table on the next page (and the chart embedded in annex 6.1) summarises the data, showing the performances by dimension and changes from baseline to endline. Positive changes are shown in blue, negative results in red.

School Name	Students	CFS EL Y3	Up/Down (BL-EL)	CFS BL Y1	CFS EL Y3 by dimension						CFS Changes Y1-Y3					
					D1	D2	D3	D4	D5	D6	D1	D2	D3	D4	D5	D6
Phum Kandal	263	2.27	0.91	1.36	2.40	2.11	2.61	2.20	2.06	2.25	1.33	1.03	1.08	0.80	0.84	0.37
Boeng Kieb	216	1.94	0.79	1.15	2.20	1.86	2.05	1.78	2.24	2.25	0.49	0.88	1.05	0.58	1.30	1.17
Hanchey Leur	714	1.70	-0.05	1.75	1.93	1.26	1.66	2.20	1.46	1.70	-0.28	0.05	0.24	-0.10	-0.14	-0.05
Hanchey Kroam	217	2.08	0.44	1.64	1.71	1.89	2.22	2.30	2.31	2.07	-0.42	0.53	1.12	0.10	0.73	0.61
Kanhcor	189	2.04	0.76	1.28	2.27	2.05	2.26	1.80	1.50	2.35	1.07	0.73	0.69	0.50	0.37	1.17
Preaek Chamlak	672	1.82	0.38	1.44	1.47	1.83	1.71	2.00	1.89	2.04	0.27	0.43	0.30	0.20	0.37	0.71
Somrong	188	2.20	1.00	1.2	2.53	2.04	2.37	2.10	1.88	2.26	0.80	1.03	1.41	0.70	0.63	1.39
Preaek Tahub	251	2.54	1.03	1.51	2.73	2.31	2.45	2.70	2.38	2.64	1.20	1.04	1.51	0.70	0.58	1.14
Pong Ro 2	513	1.71	0.14	1.57	1.87	1.67	1.37	1.90	1.56	1.89	0.34	0.47	0.08	-0.10	0.21	-0.18
Chhloung	701	1.94	0.78	1.16	2.14	1.73	1.73	2.00	1.44	2.58	0.67	0.61	0.70	0.50	0.57	1.60
Prey Ko	252	2.02	0.62	1.4	2.47	2.03	2.07	2.11	1.71	1.71	0.60	1.01	1.27	0.51	0.36	-0.03
Prama	441	1.51	0.73	0.78	1.87	1.36	1.40	1.60	1.47	1.37	0.74	0.36	0.64	1.30	0.80	0.57
Veal Kansaeng	289	2.28	0.52	1.76	2.27	2.21	2.47	2.10	2.25	2.38	0.60	0.55	0.67	0.00	0.62	0.64
Phum Thmey	182	2.09	0.68	1.41	2.80	1.86	1.99	2.50	1.44	1.96	1.40	0.77	0.88	0.50	0.09	-0.11
Pong Ro 3	478	2.00	0.59	1.41	2.40	1.78	2.15	2.40	1.38	1.87	1.19	0.54	1.04	0.30	0.11	0.37
Chhak Kantoung	205	1.80	0.09	1.71	2.07	1.66	1.56	2.10	1.38	2.01	0.14	0.22	0.04	0.10	-0.21	0.01
Kbal Khla	137	1.19	0.36	0.83	1.29	0.92	0.84	1.60	1.08	1.43	0.86	0.21	0.20	-0.10	0.39	0.63
AVERAGE:		1.95	0.57	1.37	2.14	1.80	1.94	2.08	1.73	2.04	0.65	0.62	0.76	0.38	0.45	0.59

Explanatory Note:

CFS EL Y3 = Endline results for CFS. Colours are as before. Bold markings indicate schools that managed to increase a CFS 'level' over the course of the project. At the bottom of the column is the mean – this is also marked in yellow as it is an intermediate level score.

Up/Down (BL-EL) represents the changes in the schools' overall scores from baseline to endline. For example, Phum Kandal has improved 0.91 since the baseline figure (which is in the adjacent right cell: the EL figure is 2.27, the BL figure is 1.36 so the change is +0.91). Positive changes are marked in blue, negative in red.

The coloured cells further to the right represent the endline figures by dimension. On the top left of this section, Phum Kandal scored 2.40 on the endline for Dimension 1; this is marked in green, as 2.40 is the threshold for an advanced indicator.

The right six columns break down the changes baseline-endline by dimension, using the blue/red coding as before. Phum Kandal's 1.33 in blue in D1 means that their baseline level was 1.07 (2.40 – 1.33).

4.5 Summary points of Endline(Y3) comparison with baseline(Y1)

- **Total of 16/17 schools (94%) improved their score from the baseline**
- **This is 24% (four schools) above the project target**
- Mean improvement of schools' score was +0.57
- Total of 14/17 schools (82%) improved their score sufficiently to raise their level
- One school, Prek Tahub, achieved advanced CFS level, the first in the project to do so
 - Prek Tahub was also the only school to increase by two levels
- One school had a decreased score (-0.05) which occurred mainly after a change in school leadership and was due to a reduced level from year 2 to year 3
- Disaggregating by dimensions, 6/6 dimensions were intermediate
 - This compares with 1/6 at baseline (Dimension 4: Gender)
 - Dimension (1) on access was the highest scoring level with a mean score of 2.14
 - Dimension (5) on community involvement was the lowest scoring level with a mean of 1.73
 - Only one school had any indicators at below basic level in year 3, compared with four at the baseline (and also four at the midline, but with fewer indicators in total)
 - There were six schools with advanced level indicators at endline, compared with four at the midline assessment and none at the baseline

5. Conclusion and discussion

5.1 Strong improvements

The improvements in CFS show progress across the project from baseline, through midline and at endline – despite unprecedented restrictions on learning.

This improvement is shown in nearly every school. This is a commendable achievement and strongly related to the goals of the E2L project. The mean increase of +0.57 CFS 'points' over the six dimensions shows real change.

The CFS assessment also shows clearly where schools can work to improve their performances, and this will be helpful to future work by ChildFund and partners in Chhloung district.

Target outcome met

Using the criteria of CFS scores, **Project Outcome (1) has been met**. 94% of schools improved their CFS scores over the course of the project. The result of 94% is considerably above the target of 70%. The 70% figure is a minimum of 12/17 schools (70.6%), which has been exceeded by four schools.

5.2 Teaching and Learning: Has it improved?

Many indicators for CFS status are enabling measures and do not relate directly to the school's core function of teaching and learning. The positive results shown by this assessment will need to be taken in the context of concurrent measurements of student learning outcomes (EGRA tests, being the most objective measure).

EGRA tests show a decline in reading standards over the course of the project. Whilst the consultancy team feel this is strongly due to the problems faced during the COVID pandemic, the objective measure of the schools' performance is that learning loss has occurred, despite increases in the CFS scores. Note that this is

also learning loss that has occurred whilst the CFS indicator for teaching and learning (dimension 2) has increased.

Note also that any learning loss that may have occurred during the past two years of disruptions should be compared with other schools outside the project. If learning loss is found to be greater in comparable schools, then the project's outcomes may be said to have mitigated learning loss, even if objective improvements in EG literacy were not observed.

5.3 Context of COVID-19 disruptions

In the context of the COVID-19 pandemic, where schools were shut for most of the year, a like-for-like comparison is not possible, and results should be viewed with caution. COVID measures in place should have led to schools improving their hygiene procedures and it is very much to be hoped that these improved hygiene measures are maintained in an appropriate and risk-preventative fashion.

Some of the improvements are infrastructure-related and may be attributed directly to project interventions. Again, it is to be hoped that these standards are to be maintained under more 'normal' school operating conditions.

5.4 Note of concern

Note also: within the CFS database, the only schools assessed by Chhloung DTMT in 2021 were those within the E2L project. All 17 schools were entered into the database as being assessed by the DTMT. Not one of the 18 other schools in Chhloung district is recorded with any data for 2021. **ChildFund and partners must ensure that their efforts to support selected schools does not compromise the service received by other schools in the area.**

6. Annexes

6.1 Chhloung CFS data (all three years)



20211228 CFS data
Y123.xlsx

6.2 CFS evaluation questionnaire (Khmer)



Annex2_Questionnaires of CFS in Khmer.doc

7. References

MoEYS Cambodia *Child Friendly School Policy* Ministry of Education Youth and Sports, Phnom Penh, 2007

MoEYS Cambodia *Child Friendly School Guidelines for School Based Management Committees* Ministry of Education, Youth and Sports, Phnom Penh 2018. (English version)

MoEYS/UNICEF *Joint Formative Evaluation of CFS Policy Implementation in Cambodia April-October 2016 Final Report* Ministry of Education Youth and Sports / UNICEF Country Office, Cambodia, November 2016